ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 71

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Kinyarwanda Alphabet

Inyuguti zanjye za mbere z'Ikinyarwanda

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 23 Kinyarwanda Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b C c

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Kinyarwanda Alphabet — Inyuguti zanjye za mbere z'Ikinyarwanda
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 71

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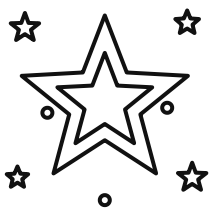
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



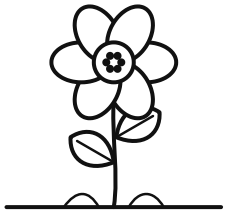
This book belongs to

Iki gitabo ni icya

I started learning Kinyarwanda on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 71 is Kinyarwanda. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** in the pronunciation show the syllable said a little more strongly: *ee-GEE-tee*. (Kinyarwanda is really a tone language: some syllables are said higher, others lower.)
- **c** always says 'ch' as in "church", and **cy** says it too.
- **r** is a light tap of the tongue, close to an 'l'.
- Sounds follow standard Kinyarwanda as taught in Rwandan schools.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Kinyarwanda name** written in Kinyarwanda (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Kinyarwanda syllables* shows how the letter is named in class and the row of syllables Rwandan children chant when they learn to read (ba be bi bo bu). Under it, the word is split into syllables so you can find the letter after the little vowel at the front.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Kinyarwanda (Rwanda).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Kinyarwanda! Ikinyarwanda

ee-kee-nyah-RWAHN-dah — the Kinyarwanda word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **12 million people** speak Kinyarwanda — almost everyone in Rwanda.[3]

Where?
In **Rwanda**, a small green country in the middle of Africa, and by families in nearby countries.

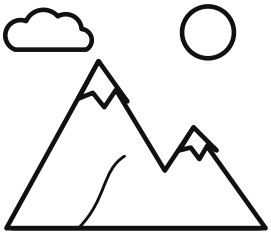
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**, almost exactly as it sounds.

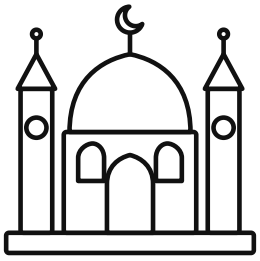
How many letters?
23 letters, plus letter teams such as **cy, ny, sh, shy**.

A thousand hills
Rwanda is called *igihugu cy'imisozi igihumbi*, "the land of a thousand hills".

Did you know?
Rwandan weavers make tall baskets with pointed lids called **agaseke**, from grass and sisal, in beautiful zigzag patterns.





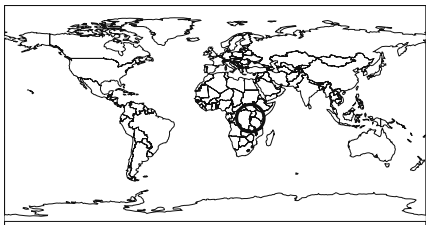


The Kinyarwanda Alphabet inyuguti

23 letters — inyuguti

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Cc** *chah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*
Gg *gah*	**Hh** *hah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Mm** *mah*
Nn *nah*	**Oo** *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*
Uu *oo*	**Vv** *vah*	**Ww** *wah*	**Yy** *yah*	**Zz** *zah*	

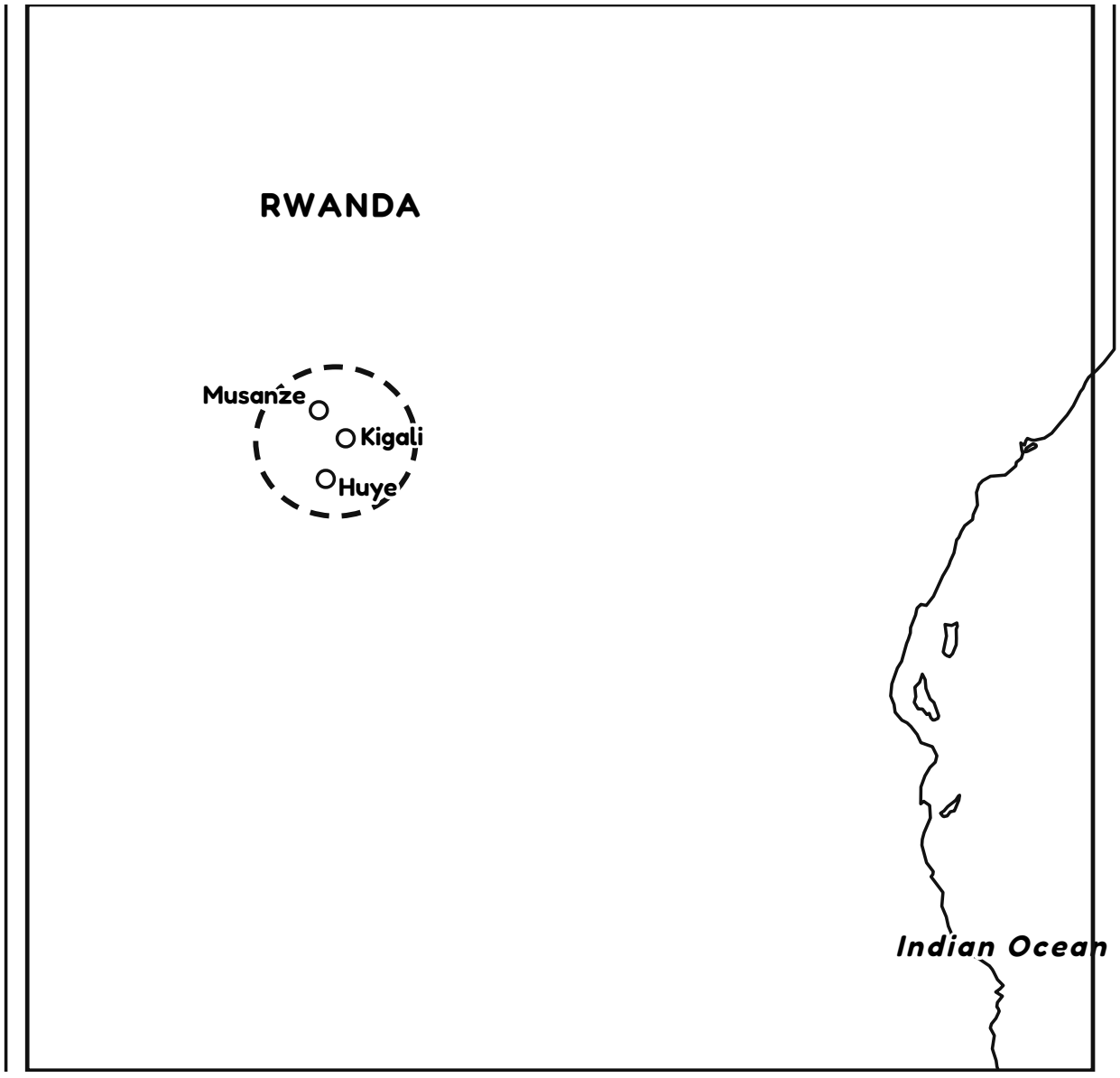
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the middle of Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Kinyarwanda spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Kinyarwanda is spoken all over Rwanda: in the capital Kigali, in Huye and in Musanze near the volcanoes. The dashed line shows Rwanda.

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THE LETTERS

The Letters inyuguti

ee-nyoo-GOO-tee — “the letters”

Kinyarwanda is written with **23 letters**: the English alphabet without **L**, **Q** and **X** (they appear only in a few borrowed words).

A little vowel in front
Most Kinyarwanda names of things begin with a small vowel: **i-**, **u-** or **a-**: *inzu* (house), *ubuki* (honey), *amazi* (water). So on many pages you will find the letter **right after** that little vowel: *i·**g**iti* (tree).

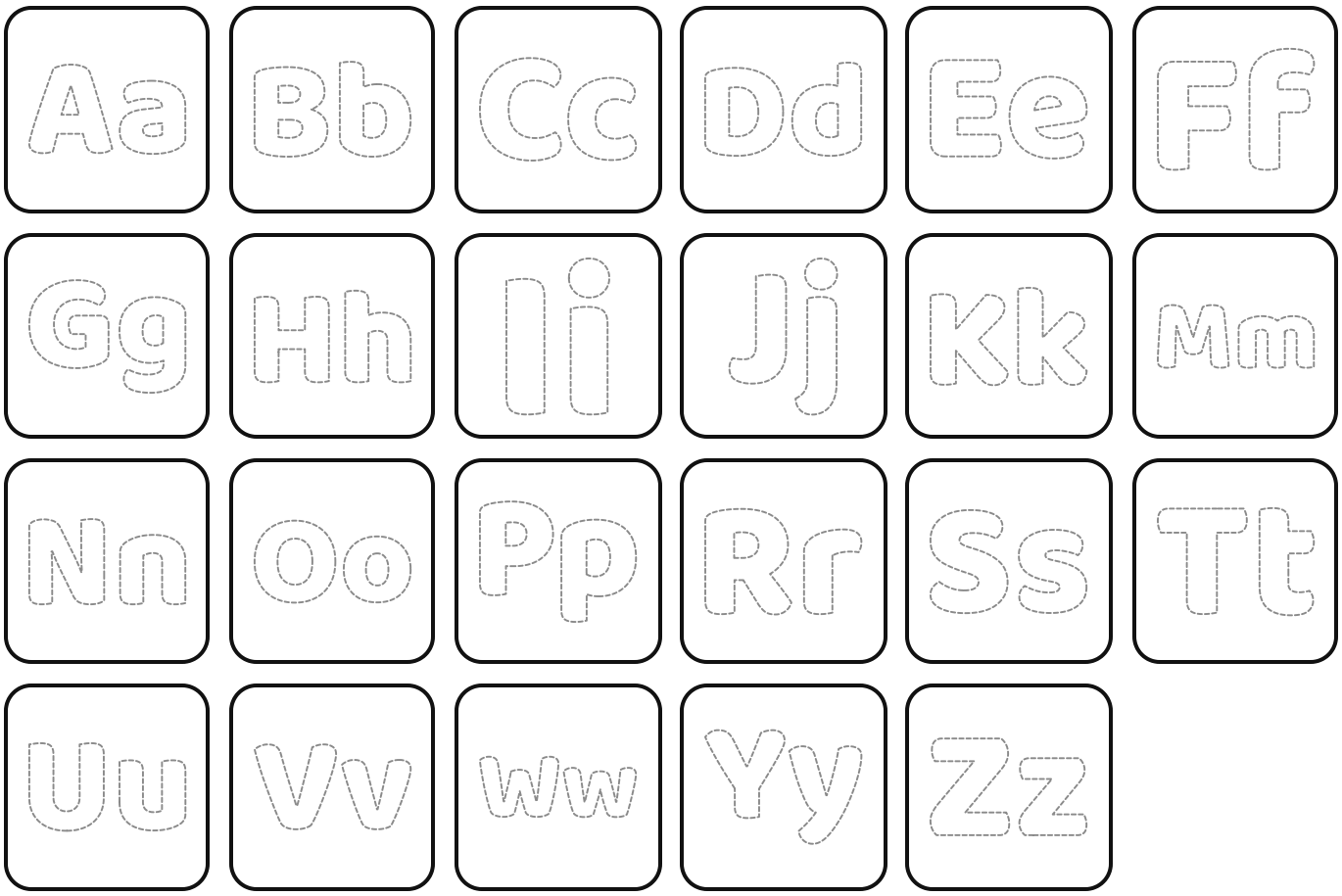
Read in syllables
Rwandan children learn to read syllable by syllable: *ba be bi bo bu*, *ca ce ci co cu*… Letters team up too: **cy, ny, sh, shy, mb, nz**…

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters inyuguti

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · IZINA

a

ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · ka · ma · na



AA **IS FOR**

agaseke

ah-gah-SEH-keh

woven basket with a lid

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · IZINA

ba

bah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

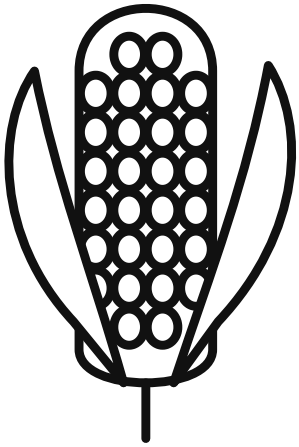
a soft ‘b’, the lips almost touching

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · b · be · b · bi · b · bo · b · bu

The word begins with a little vowel. Find **b** right after it: *i · bi · go · ri*



BB IS FOR

ibigori

ee-bee-GOH-ree

maize cobs (corn)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Cc

NAME · IZINA

ca

chah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

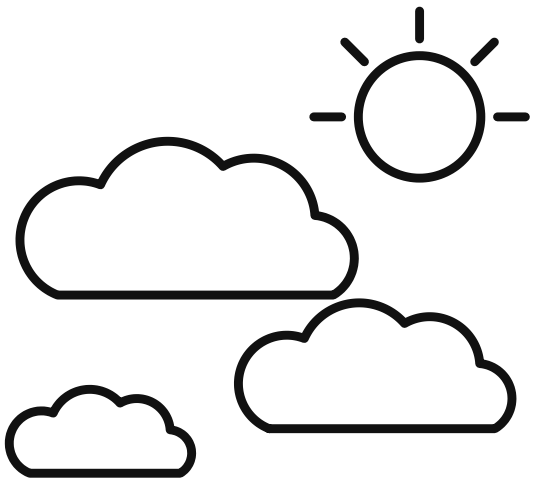
‘ch’ as in “church”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

C c — «ca»

ca · c · ce · c · ci · c · co · c · cu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **c** right after it: *i · gi · cu*



CC IS FOR

igicu

ee-gee-CHOO

cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Cc Cc Cc Cc

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Dd

NAME · IZINA

da

dah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

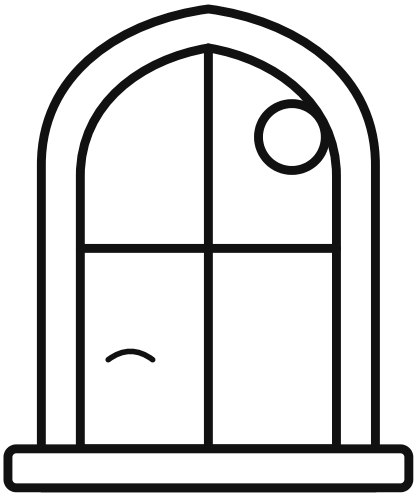
‘d’ as in “day”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · d · de · d · di · d · do · d · du

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **d** right after it: *i · di · ri · shya*



DD IS FOR

idirishya

ee-dee-REE-shyah

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · IZINA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

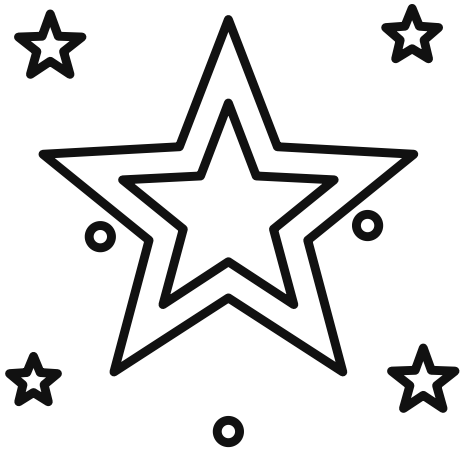
‘e’ as in “bed”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · ke · me · ne

Few words begin with E. Can you find it inside *inyenyeri*?



EE IS FOR

inyenyeri

ee-nyeh-NYEH-ree

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · IZINA

fa

fah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

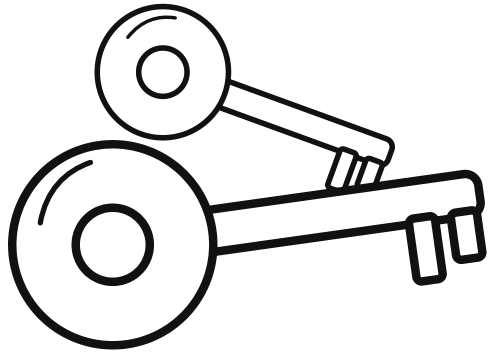
‘f’ as in “fan”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · f · fe · f · fi · f · fo · f · fu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **f** right after it: *u · ru · fu · ngu · zo*



FF IS FOR

urufunguzo

oo-roo-foon-GOO-zoh

key

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · IZINA

ga

gah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

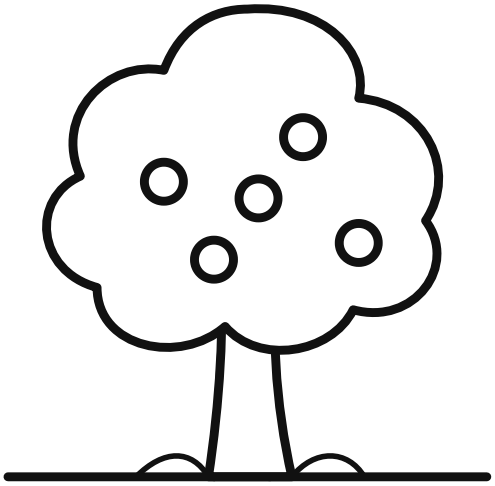
‘g’ as in “go”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · g · ge · g · gi · g · go · g · gu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **g** right after it: *i · gi · ti*



GG IS FOR

igiti

ee-GEE-tee

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · IZINA

ha

hah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

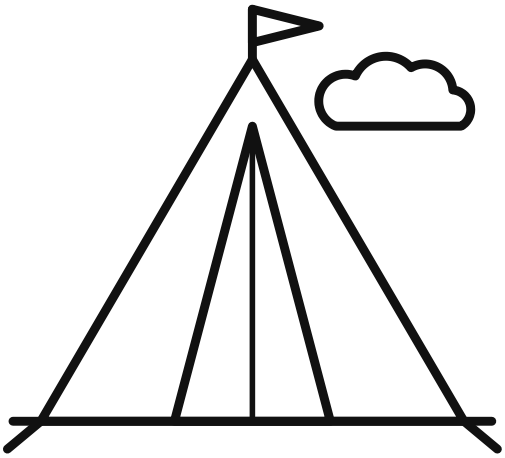
a soft, breathy ‘h’ as in “hat”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · h · he · h · hi · h · ho · h · hu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **h** right after it: *i · he · ma*



HH IS FOR

ihema

ee-HEH-mah

tent

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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ii

NAME · IZINA

i

ee

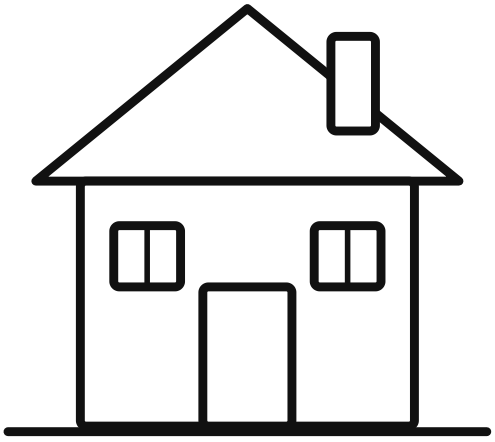
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · ki · mi · ni



II IS FOR

inzu

EEN-zoo

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

ii ii ii ii

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Jj

NAME · IZINA

ja

jah

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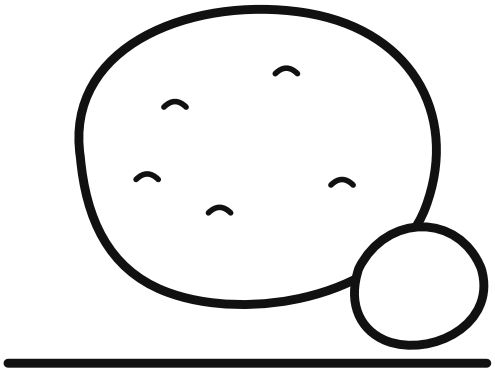
‘j’ as in “jam”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · j · je · j · ji · j · jo · j · ju

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **j** right after it: *i · bi · ju · mba*



JJ IS FOR

ibijumba

ee-bee-JOOM-bah

sweet potatoes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · IZINA

ka

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

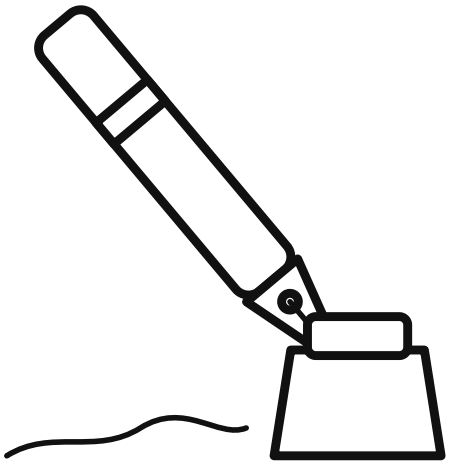
‘k’ as in “kite”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · k · ke · k · ki · k · ko · k · ku

The word begins with a little vowel. Find **k** right after it: *i · ka · ra · mu*



KK IS FOR

ikaramu

ee-kah-RAH-moo

pen, pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Mm

NAME · IZINA

ma

mah

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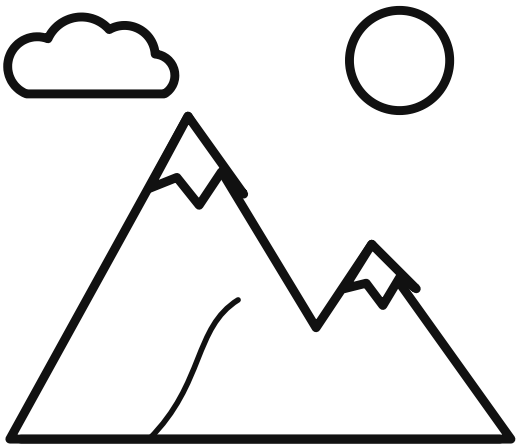
‘m’ as in “moon”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · m · me · m · mi · m · mo · m · mu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **m** right after it: *u · mu · so · zi*



MM IS FOR

umusozi

oo-moo-SOH-zee

hill, mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · IZINA

na

nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

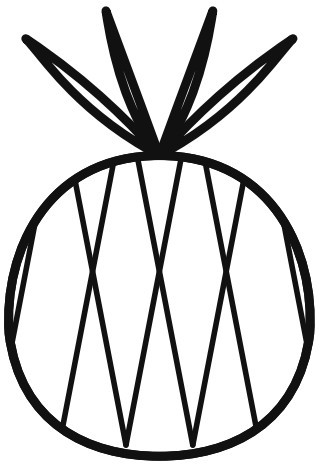
KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · n · ne · n · ni · n · no · n · nu

ny = ‘ny’ as in “canyon”

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **n** right after it: *i · na · na · si*



NN IS FOR

inanasi

ee-nah-NAH-see

pineapple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · IZINA

O

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

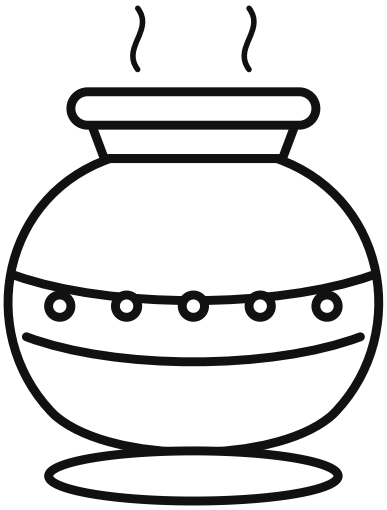
‘o’ as in “for” — short and pure

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · ko · mo · no

Few words begin with O. Can you find it inside *inkono*?



OO IS FOR

inkono

een-KOH-noh

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · IZINA

pa

pah

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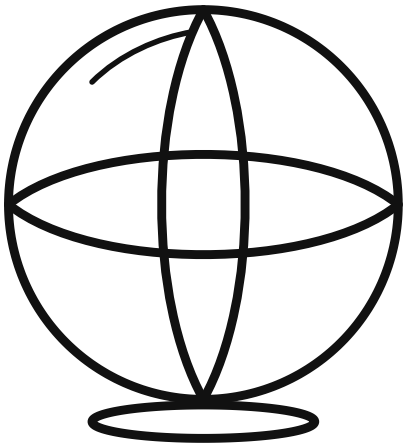
‘p’ as in “pen”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · p · pe · p · pi · p · po · p · pu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **p** right after it: *u · mu · pi · ra*



PP IS FOR

umupira

oo-moo-PEE-rah

ball

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Rr

NAME · IZINA

ra

rah

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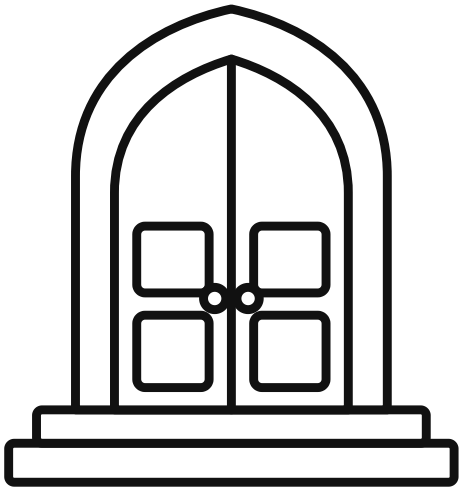
a light, tapped ‘r’ — almost an ‘l’

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · r · re · r · ri · r · ro · r · ru

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **r** right after it: *u · ru · gi*



RR IS FOR

urugi

oo-ROO-gee

door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss Ss

NAME · IZINA

sa

sah

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‘s’ as in “sun”

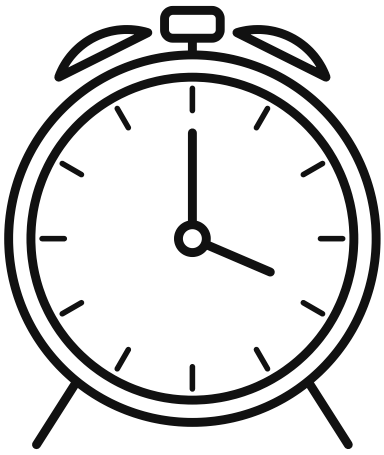
KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · s · se · s · si · s · so · s · su

sh = ‘sh’ as in “shoe”

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **s** right after it: *i · sa · ha*



SS IS FOR

isaha

ee-SAH-hah

clock, watch

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · IZINA

ta

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · t · te · t · ti · t · to · t · tu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **t** right after it: *u · mu · ta · ka*



TT IS FOR

umutaka

oo-moo-TAH-kah

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · IZINA

u

oo

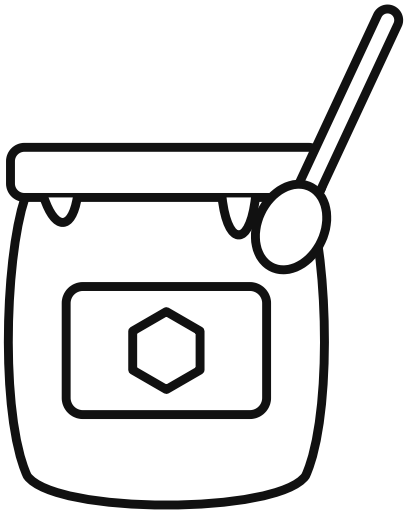
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · ku · mu · nu



UU IS FOR

ubuki

oo-BOO-kee

honey

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Vv

NAME · IZINA

va

vah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ as in “van”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

V v — «va»

va · v · ve · v · vi · v · vo · v · vu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **v** right after it: *i · mvu · ra*



VV IS FOR

imvura

eem-VOO-rah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · IZINA

wa

wah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

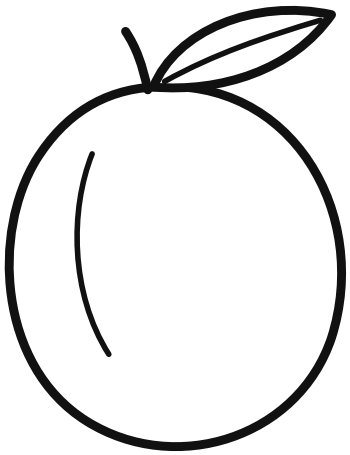
‘w’ as in “water”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · w · we · w · wi · w · wo · w · wu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **w** right after it: *u · mwe · mbe*



WW **IS FOR**

umwembe

oo-MWEHM-beh

mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Yy

NAME · IZINA

ya

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · y · ye · y · yi · y · yo · y · yu

cy = ‘ch’ as in “church”

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **y** right after it: *i · cya · yi*



YY IS FOR

icyayi

ee-CHAH-yee

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · IZINA

za

zah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

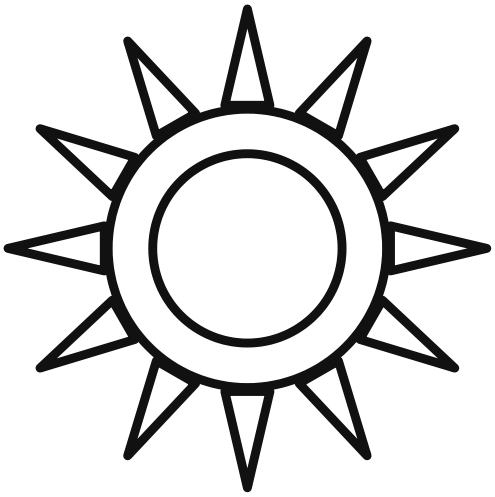
‘z’ as in “zoo”

KINYARWANDA SYLLABLES

Z z — «za»

za · z · ze · z · zi · z · zo · z · zu

The word begins with a little vowel.
Find **z** right after it: *i · zu · ba*



ZZ IS FOR

izuba

ee-ZOO-bah

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Zz Zz Zz Zz

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BONUS

Kinyarwanda numbers imibare *(ee-mee-BAH-reh)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Kinyarwanda: *ZEH-roo*, *REE-mweh*, *kah-BEE-ree*, *gah-TAH-too*...



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LET'S TALK

My first Kinyarwanda words Amagambo ya mbere

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaykum

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaykum assalam

wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

Muraho!

moo-RAH-hoh
Hello!

Nitwa ...

NEE-twah ...
My name is ...

Murakoze

moo-rah-KOH-zeh
Thank you

Jazakallahu khayran

jah-zah-KAH-lah-hoo KHAY-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

mama · data

MAH-mah · DAH-tah
Mother · Father

musaza · mushiki

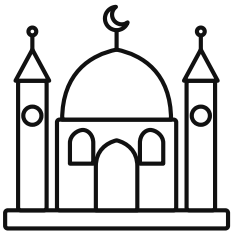
moo-SAH-zah · moo-SHEE-kee
Brother · Sister

yego · oya

YEH-goh · OH-yah
Yes · No

Ndiga Ikinyarwanda!

NDEE-gah ee-kee-nyah-RWAHN-dah
I am learning Kinyarwanda!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

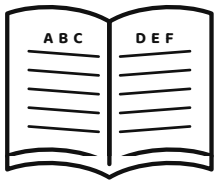
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

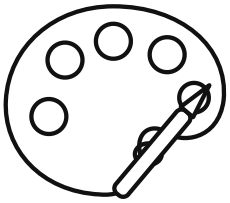
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **23 Kinyarwanda letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Kinyarwanda, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Wakoze neza!

MAH-shah-lah! wah-KOH-zeh NEH-zah! — Well done, you did it well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 23 letters of the Kinyarwanda alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
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مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.